

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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THE BELIEVER'S RESPONSE TO GOD'S REQUEST

OUR SUBJECT: "WHAT THEN SHALL WE SAY IN RESPONSE TO THESE THINGS"?

Romans 8:31 What, then, shall we say in response to this? If God is for us, who can be against us? NIV

Romans 8:31 What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? NKJV

GOD'S CALL - TO EVERY BELIEVER FOR A RESPONSE TO WHAT HE HAD DECLARED.

- * **WHAT** A significant message for us to seriously consider as we continue into this new year.
- * **WHAT WILL WE DO WHEN GOD CONFRONTS US?**
Job 31:14 what will I do when God confronts me? What will I answer when called to account? NIV
- * **WHAT IS OUR RESPONSE WHEN GOD CONFRONTS US WITH DIVINE TRUTH**
- * **WHAT IS OUR RESPONSE TO THIS TRUTH IN ROMANS 8:31?**
Romans 8:31 What, then, shall we say in response to this? If God is for us, who can be against us? NIV (Note the Word IF really means SINCE God is for us. NIV
- **BECAUSE GOD HAS SAID – WE CAN ALSO CONFIDENTLY SAY EXACTLY WHAT HE HAS COMMITTED HIMSELF TO – WE DECLARE 'THE AMEN' (Amen means agreement with)**
*Hebrews 13:5-6 states: **GOD HAS SAID**, "Never will I leave you; never will I forsake you." - **SO, WE SAY WITH CONFIDENCE**, "The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me. NIV*
- **GOD IN SCRIPTURE HAS DECLARED CERTAIN TRUTHS THAT HE WANTS TO KNOW WHAT OUR RESPONSE TO THEM.**
 - * He wants to know if we agree with them or not?
 - * The exercise of God confronting us with a response is part of the process of getting the believer to THINK and to MAKE a choice.
 - * OUR response is essential for growth and strengthening of our walk with Christ.
 - * Are we **fully convinced** with those truths presented in Scripture.
 - * Now we maybe someone who is still struggling to accept or believe all that God has said – but at least **we can respond by telling God** that we desire to believe it and would like some help in doing that.
 - * What God says **IS** true, **but is it TRUE TO YOU today** - at this moment?
 - * The exercise of God demanding a response from us is to bring us to a place of effectively dealing with genuine doubt and hesitation.
- **OUR POSITIVE RESPONSE OF AGREEMENT TO WHAT GOD SAYS BRINGS US INTO A NEW SENSE OF ASSURANCE AND CONFIDENCE IN CHRIST.**
 - * Our emotions tell us one thing and God's Word tells us another. Often our emotions and feelings fluctuate and cannot be relied upon to be a good guide to making decisions or taking action.
 - * **BUT GOD'S WORD NEVER CHANGES AND CAN ALWAYS BE RELIED UPON.**
 - * Most believers give mental ascent to that fact, **but the purpose of this study is to actually get us to practice responding to God's demand by declaring the Amen on a regular daily basis.**

EXAMPLE: WHAT DO WE SAY:

- * **WHEN GOD STATES OR DECLARES SOMETHING IN THE BIBLE AND THEN ASKS FOR A RESPONSE – WE NEED TO RESPOND.**
- **WE NEED TO GIVE A RESPONSE AS TO WHAT OUR POSITION IS IN RELATION TO THAT PARTICULAR TRUTH DECLARED IN SCRIPTURE?**
- * It is like what Job states, **what do I believe and hold to when God confronts me** and I'm called to **give account**. *Job 31:14 what will I do when God confronts me? What will I answer when called to account? NIV*
- * What shall we say then to these things?

WHAT THEN ARE WE TO SAY ABOUT THESE THINGS? Romans 8:31-35

- * **God is for us** – then who is strong enough to be against God.
- * **God offered up** his son for us how will he not grant with the things we require?
- * **God is the one** who justified us, so he is not about to bring accusation against us.
- * **God is not the one** who condemns us because Christ died for us and rose to justify us.
- * **Nothing** can separate us from Christ's love.

WHAT IS YOUR RESPONSE TO THESE THINGS

- * **ARE THEY A REALITY TO YOU?**
- * **HOW CAN WE DOUBT GOD'S INTENTION AND COMMITMENT TO US AFTER READING WHAT GOD SAYS?**

Romans 8:31-34

31 **What, then, shall we say in response to this?** If God is for us, **who can be against us?**

32 He who did not spare his own Son, **but gave him up for us all** — how will he not also, along with him, **graciously give us all things?**

33 Who will bring any charge against those whom God has chosen? *It is God who justifies.*

34 Who is he that condemns? **Christ Jesus, who died** — more than that, **who was raised to life** — is at the right hand of God and is also **interceding for us**. NIV

THE ILLUSTRATION - OF JUSTIFICATION

■ **ARE WE MADE RIGHT WITH GOD THROUGH BEING JUSTIFIED?**

■ What shall we say to the fact **that Abraham was justified by faith alone without the works of the Law?**

■ **Do we try to do things for God for the purpose of trying to gain some advantage before / with him?**
Romans 4:1-3

1 **What then shall we say** that Abraham, our ancestor according to the flesh, has discovered regarding this matter?

2 For if Abraham was declared righteous by the works of the law, he has something to boast about - but not before God.

3 **For what does the scripture say?** "Abraham **believed** God, and it was **credited** to him as righteousness." NET

Romans 3:28 **For we hold** that one is justified by faith **apart from works** of the law. ESV

DO WE HOLD TO (believe) THIS TRUTH ALSO?

Romans 6:1-2

1 **What shall we say, then?** **Shall we go on sinning** so that grace may increase?

2 **By no means!** **We died to sin; how can we live in it any longer?** NIV

WHAT THEN SHALL WE SAY? - IS GOD UNJUST OR PARTIAL?

Romans 9:14-16

14 **What then shall we say? Is God unjust?** Not at all!

15 For he says to Moses, "I will have mercy on whom I have mercy, and I will have compassion on whom I have compassion."

16 It does not, therefore, depend on man's desire or effort, but on God's mercy. NIV

WHAT THEN SHALL WE SAY? - Have the Gentile's obtained righteousness and are now God's chosen ones?

Romans 9:30-31

30 **What then shall we say?** That the Gentiles, who did not pursue righteousness, **have obtained it**, a righteousness that is by faith,

31 but Israel, who pursued a law of righteousness, has not attained it. NIV